

lines of varying thickness are scanned, it only managed to scan the blocks as just one single box, failing to reproduce the fine lines therein.

This scanner comes with a host of bundled applications including Scan Manager, Photo Express SE 3.0 and Readiris 5.0 OCR software,

Price: Rs 4,950

Contact: Neoteric Informatique

Phone: 022-4172600

Fax: 022-4185294

E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com

Web site: www.neoteric-info.com

making it one of the better package deals. With a price tag under Rs 5,000 and its ability to scan at 1200 dpi, it is a good buy for the home and the SoHo segment.

SPECIFICATIONS

48-bit scanner, USB interface, no external power required

Umax Astra Slim 600 B+	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Saitek Cyborg 3D Gold joystick

Sheer joy

Cyborg has looks that'll make any gamer drool. The joystick has 12 buttons, all of which can be customised for use with different games. The rubberised rest pad ensures that your hands won't suffer from repeated stress injury (RSI) after those long-drawn dog fights. This pad can even be adjusted for height. The joystick can be moved on its own axis (the Z-axis) and this feature can be configured to control the rudder in flight simulation games. The eight-way hat switch lets you look around in a flight simulation, giving you the advantage of 'situational awareness'.

This joystick, however, is not meant for first person shootouts and racing games, although one can configure it to play them. The package includes Saitek Gaming Extension, a utility that lets



you program the buttons for different gaming needs—it lets you program multiple keystrokes and assign them to a single button for easier execution of combination moves.

You can use Saitek Gaming Extension to create profiles for different games. This profile can be automatically loaded when you start the game, doing away with the bother of setting controller options every time a new game is started.

This joystick is best used for flight simulation (both aircraft and helicopter) games. The price is relatively affordable considering the number of features, the build quality and the sheer looks it offers.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB interface, eight fully programmable buttons, eight-way hat switch

Saitek Cyborg 3D Gold A-	
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Ease of use	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Price: Rs 2,990

Contact: Origin Marketing

Phone: 022-8801335

Fax: 022-8835886

E-mail: origin121@vsnl.com

Web site: www.origin121.com

Iomega USB 2.0 portable hard disk

Small is smart

This 20 GB external portable hard drive weighs 230 grams and has an easy-to-carry form factor. Although the drive is USB 2.0 compliant, it works fine with the older USB 1.1 interface found



on most PCs as well. When tested for data transfer speed, the drive logged a transfer rate of 4 MBps (sequential write) from an IDE drive attached to the system.

The installation is slightly different from the other USB devices available—the driver needs to be installed before the device is plugged in and only then does the installation proceed. The power plug supplied with the device has flat pins and not the usual rounded ones, so you will have to buy a converter for the power cord. The software bundled

with the drive includes Iomega Backup software, Quick Sync software to sync files and backup the data on the portable hard drive, and Music Match Jukebox. With effortless installation, smooth usage and commendable data transfer rates for an external storage device, transferring large files between locations is a snap with this drive.

SPECIFICATIONS

20 GB USB 2.0 external drive, base unit weighs 150 grams, docking/power unit weighs 80 grams, includes a USB 2.0 card

Iomega USB 2.0 A-	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Price: Rs 12,500

Contact: Ingram Micro India Ltd

Phone: 022-5550604

Fax: 022-5550605

E-mail: manish@imindia.com



Afzal Mazgaonkar

Video Editor,
Media Studio

Iomega USB 2.0 has enough space for huge files and USB 2.0 connectivity speeds up the transfer time